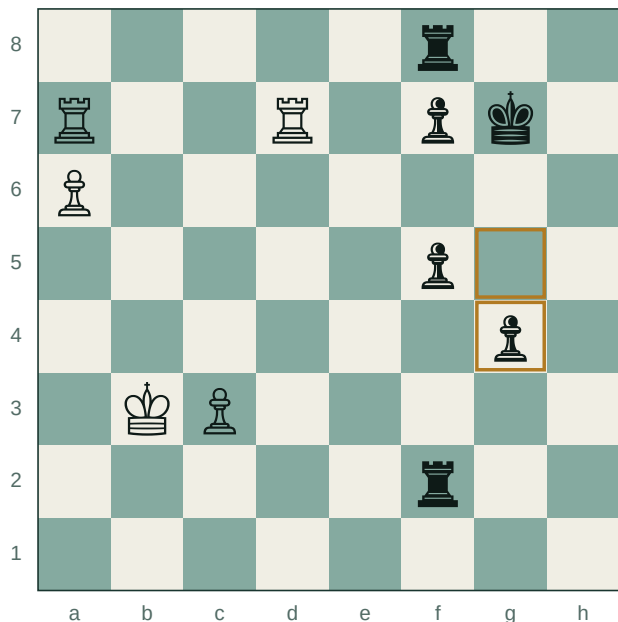


Calculated sacrifices: White, move 45

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 44...g4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45. Rxf7+ Rxf7 46. Rxf7+ Kxf7 47. a7

45.Rxf7+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From f7 it attacks king on g7 and rook on f8. Recorded reply: **45...Rxf7**.

46.Rxf7+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on f7. Recorded reply: **46...Kxf7**.

47.a7 The pawn moves from a6 to a7.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -4: the balance goes from -1 to -5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g7. Absolute pin: pawn on f7.